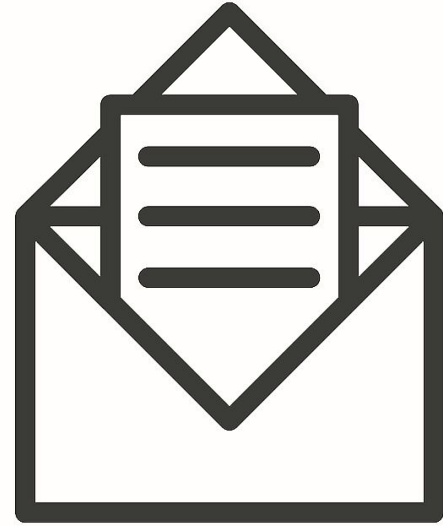


# Lesson 9: Flipping perspectives

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2  
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective 1/2

**Understand bidirectional  
communication of information  
sender and receiver**

# Letter to the Editor

News media often collect and display valuable readers' feedback.

## Letter to the EDITOR

Dear Editor,

The Loyolan published an article last week about an incident that took place a few weeks ago, which resulted in a non-LMU student being taken to the hospital at an event allegedly "hosted by Crimson Circle." I would like to voice a few of my concerns regarding the inaccuracies of this article and its depiction of Crimson Circle.

To begin, as the president of Crimson Circle, I can assure you that this event was not hosted, sponsored, or affiliated with our organization. This event was not publicized by Crimson, nor was it ever intended to be. While members of the organization reside at this home, other unaffiliated individuals do as well. With this being said, I appreciate the efforts made by the Loyolan to correct its initial wording, but this residence is simply an off campus residence and the labeling of it as a "Crimson Circle residence" significantly misinforms your readers.

Additionally, I feel that comments in this article do not accurately illustrate the values and mission of our organization. Crimson Circle is dedicated to serving both our LMU and greater Los Angeles community. An example of our positive contributions can be seen in another article that you published last week about our efforts to promote the LMU Bi-annual Blood Drive, together with our presence at local elementary schools and nonprofit organizations throughout Los Angeles.

The individuals living at this residence, both Crimson members and not, were responsible in ensuring the safety and well being of this non-LMU student. I feel that the Loyolan should be working toward informing our students of the positive and responsible contributions that our students and student organizations are making within our community. There is so much good that radiates from this campus, and that is what I would like to see promoted and praised.

Thank you,

Harrison Husting  
President '16  
Crimson Circle service organization

## Conversation

### WHAT YOU SAID ABOUT...

**THE COVID WINTER** After reading Jamie Ducharme's Nov. 30/Dec. 7 cover story on the potential for a COVID-19 surge this winter, readers marveled at how America could have ended up in such a predicament. "The most depressing cover ever," wrote Colleen Badenhop of Beavercreek, Ohio, of the frosty windowpane warning created for TIME by London-based artists Sean Freeman and Eve Steben. Enrique Puertos of Cleveland, Ga., argued that the spread of COVID-19 misinformation was as alarming as the spread of the virus itself. "Social media platforms are the superspreaders," he wrote. "The callous attitude of a sizable section of people toward this life-threatening pandemic has led to a disturbing trend of conscious ignorance," added Prithvi De of



**'Wearing a mask is smart. Grippers who balk ... should be given a choice: a mask or a dunce cap.'**

CHASE WEBB,  
Portland, Ore.

Waukesha, Wis., "when we actually need to be together, take precautions and collectively fight this pandemic."

Readers were also attuned to how the pandemic has accentuated the pain and sadness of all our losses this past year, singular and collective. Lewis Bloom of Los Angeles said he "will never forget" W.J. Hennigan's "so well-researched" feature on a woman's journey to burial on New York City's Hart Island, where a mass graveyard for unclaimed or unidentified corpses is situated. And Debbie Kline of Milford, Conn., said Nicole Chung's op-ed on mourning her mother during the pandemic articulated everything she felt losing her own mother this past spring, and offered hope to others in their position: "The essay will hit home with thousands of people as we have navigated, and continue to do so, through these trying times. The human spirit is resilient. We will get through this. There are better days ahead."

### TALK TO US

SEND AN EMAIL:

[letters@time.com](mailto:letters@time.com)

Please do not send attachments

FOLLOW US:

[facebook.com/time](https://www.facebook.com/time)

@time (Twitter and Instagram)

Letters should include the writer's full name, address and home

# Submit a Letter to The Editor

*Learn how to submit a letter to the editor of The New York Times and about our selection process.*

The New York Times encourages a diversity of voices and views in our letters.

Thomas Feyer, the New York Times letters editor, provides tips for getting your letter published in his article [Editors' Note; The Letters Editor and the Reader: Our Compact, Updated](#).

## Submission Requirements

## Selection Process and Timeline

### Selection Process and Timeline

Because of the large volume of submissions we receive, we cannot personally acknowledge each submission.

- Writers of letters selected for publication will generally be notified within a week.
- Letters may be edited and shortened for space.

### Submission Requirements

To be considered for publication, letters should:

- Preferably be 150 to 200 words.
- Generally refer to an article that has appeared within the past seven days.
- Include the writer's city or town and phone number.
- Not contain attachments.
- Be exclusive to The New York Times. We do not publish open letters or third-party letters.

# Try reading information from a perspective of an

- **E**valuator

- Is it news or opinions?
  - News  $\Rightarrow$  Is it true? [\*SIFT]
  - Opinions  $\Rightarrow$  What is the main claim and evidence/analysis? Does the claim look good [\*ASMR] and make sense?
- Is it valuable? How? Perhaps it can...
  - be added to your cocktail party knowledge
  - enrich your encounter with the unknown side of the world
  - change your existing belief and reshape it
  - strengthen your existing belief
  - help your decision making

# Try reading information from a perspective of a

- **P**otential re-generator of the information
  - Is it relevant to what you are doing to say? How? Perhaps it can...
    - work as evidence for your claim
    - work as counter-evidence for your claim
    - contribute as part of your explanatory piece
- **L**earner of various communication styles
  - Is the article well organized?
  - Is the arrangement of contents and visuals effective?
  - Does the article start with an attractive hook?
  - Does the main message appear clearly?

# Group Activity 1: Instructions

**\*\* FOR USE BY INSTRUCTOR ONLY \*\***

Number of participants: 2 students; depending on the section, you can make it a group work

Length of activity: 20 minutes

Instructor and TAs move around the classroom, pop in and out of different groups

# Group work

This week's reflection (Google form) will ask you about a recent news article that you apply the SIFT method. Find an interesting case you would like to report!

Find the Google Doc in your Google Classroom

Engage the EPL attitude to your assessment!

- **Evaluator**

- Is it news or opinions?
  - News ⇒ Is it true? [\*SIFT]
  - Opinions ⇒ What is the main claim and evidence/analysis? Does the claim look good [\*ASMR] and make sense?
- Is it valuable? How? Perhaps it can...
  - be added to your cocktail party knowledge
  - enrich your encounter with the unknown side of the world
  - change your existing belief and reshape it
  - strengthen your existing belief
  - help your decision making

- **Potential re-generator of the information**

- Is it relevant to what you are doing to say? How? Perhaps it can...
  - work as evidence for your claim
  - work as counter-evidence for your claim
  - contribute as part of your explanatory piece

- **Learner of various communication styles**

- Is the article well organized?
- Is the arrangement of contents and visuals effective?
- Does the article start with an attractive hook?
- Does the main message appear clearly?



Today's learning objective 2/2

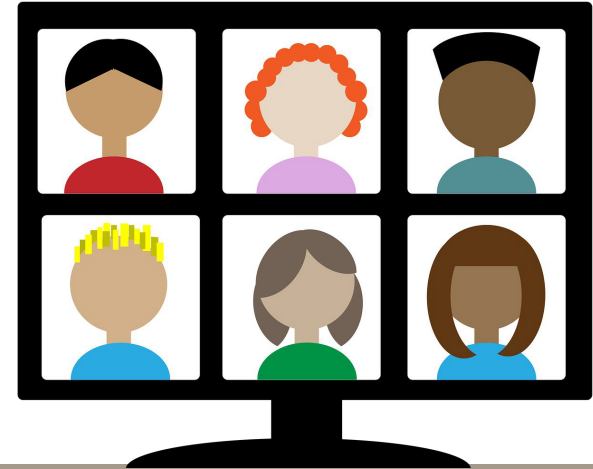
**Mind your audience: Appeal to  
logos, ethos, and pathos,  
effective and relevant to the  
target audience.**

# Video Cover letter

Have you heard about “a cover letter”? What is it?

- A video overview of you and your accomplishments
- Accompanies a resume
- Short! Less than one minute
- Think: movie trailer

**What would you make a video cover letter for?**



# Components of a video cover letter

Include:

- Your name
- The position you are applying for
- A description of your skills & abilities
- Brief description of your work experience or academic experience
- Why you are a good candidate for the position
- A closing remark



Use keywords from the job description to connect your skills and experience to the position

# Designing a VCL

Establish the rhetorical situation

- Audience: Who will hear the message?
- Purpose: What do you hope to accomplish?
- Message: What message do you want to send?
- Context: What is the situation for which you are creating this cover letter?

# Sample VCL

- Who is the audience?
- What is the purpose?
- What message is he trying to send?
- What is the context?



# Ethos, Pathos, Logos: Three Ways to Appeal to Audience

## ETHOS:



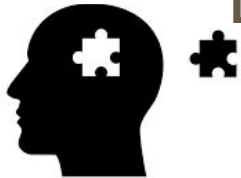
- Establishing your personal credibility
- Getting your audience to *trust*
- *Example: "In my seventeen years as a top infectious disease doctor..."*

## PATHOS:



- Inspiring an emotional response
- Getting your audience to *feel*
- *Example: "As I held the hand of my sick patient..."*

## LOGOS:



- Arguing based on reasoning and facts
- Getting your audience to *think*
- *Example: "Fourteen peer-reviewed articles conclude that..."*

# How to present in your VCL

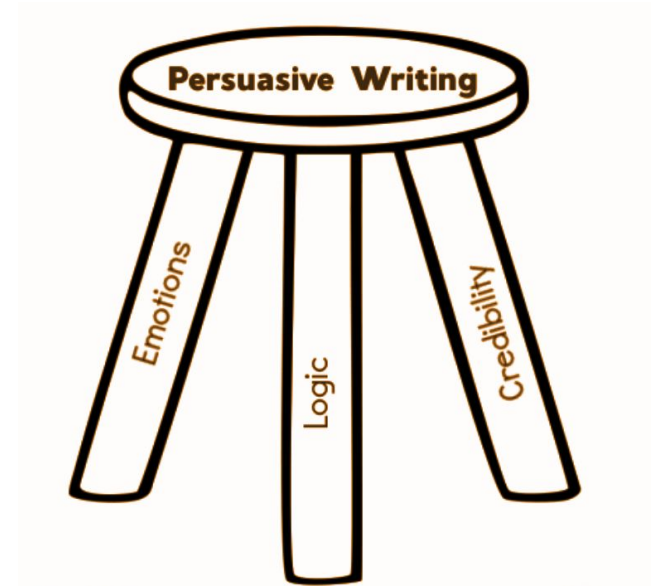
- Use rhetorical techniques where appropriate:
  - Ethos
  - Pathos
  - Logos
- Appear appropriately professional
- Match the company's tone of voice

**Which of the three rhetorical appeals is most appropriate for a video cover letter? Why?**

# VCL as a type of persuasive writing

Make your interviewers relate to your life

Appeal to their minds, ethics, and hearts



Source: <http://www.nonprofitcopywriter.com/persuasive-writing-basics.html>



# Group activity

- Shailza is applying for an internship which requires a video cover letter.
- Based on her persona and the internship details, prepare an outline for the video cover letter
  - You will have more specific instructions in the following slides.
  - You can assume that Shaliza will introduce her name and what position she is applying for.

## 2026 Summer Internship: Student Researcher Intern

### Min Qualifications:

- Currently pursuing a Bachelor's, Master's, or PhD degree in Computer Engineering, Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Math or related technical field.
- Experience in one area of Computer Science (e.g., Natural Language Processing, Computer Vision, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Algorithmic Foundations of Optimization, Quantum Information Science, Data Science, Software Engineering, or similar)

### Preferred qualifications:

- Currently enrolled in a full-time degree program
- Relevant experience as a researcher, including internships, full-time, or at a lab.
- Experience contributing research communities or efforts, including publishing papers in major conferences or journals.
- Experience with one or more general purpose programming languages, including: C/C++, Java, MATLAB, Go, and Python.
- Ability to speak and write in English fluently.

### About the internship:

The Student Researcher position offers the opportunity to work directly with Google research scientists and engineers on cutting-edge research projects. The topics student researchers work on tend to be open-ended and exploratory, and don't always have a clear deliverable like a traditional internship would.

Google Research is working on projects that utilize the latest computer science techniques. Google Research teams collaborate closely with other teams across Google.

# SHAILZA

Shailza is a city-girl who loves hanging out with friends who code and drinks large amounts of coffee. She also runs a Youtube Channel for Beginners in Artificial Intelligence.

## Profile

20, Hyderabad  
BSc (H) Comp.Sc. (2028)  
- Ongoing at IIT Hyderabad  
Living in the university hostel  
Long-term goal: start her own tech-company

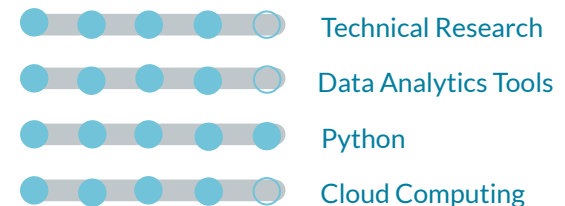
## Experience

Research Intern, AI, Facebook (Summer, 2025)  
Co-presenter, Conference on Data Analytics at IIT,  
Chair at Undergraduate, College Coders Club

## Personality



## Skills



Choose two rhetorical appeals and explain where you can use them in the letter.

# VCL outline

## I. Description of Shaliza's skills and abilities:

A. \_\_\_\_\_

B. \_\_\_\_\_

(What keywords might you use from the job description?)

## II. Shaliza's relevant work experience or academic experience

A. \_\_\_\_\_

B. \_\_\_\_\_

(What keywords might you use from the job description?)

## III. Why Shaliza is a good candidate for the position

A. \_\_\_\_\_

B. \_\_\_\_\_

(What keywords might you use from the job description?)

Shailza: a city-girl, hanging out with friends who code, drinking lots of coffee, running a Youtube channel for AI Beginners

- ## Profile

## 20, Hyderabad

BSc (H) Comp.Sc. (2028)

- Ongoing at IIT Hyderabad

## Living in the university hostel

Long-term goal: start her own tech-company

Organized 

Ambitious 

Self-Confidence 

Working with people 

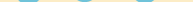
## Research Intern, AI, Facebook (Summer, 2025)

Co-presenter, Conference on Data Analytics  
at IIT,

## Chair at Undergraduate, College Coders Club


Technical Research

Data Analytics Tools

 Python

Cloud Computing

Google Research is working on projects that utilize the latest computer science techniques. Google Research teams collaborate closely with other teams across Google.

# Debrief

How did you use the keywords to help you determine what Shaliza should share?

What appeals did you choose for each section?

- Skills and abilities
- Experience
- Good fit for job

## Next class

We will continue to help Shailza, and create a script of her VCL.